EGOCRAFT · VERSION 0.4.0 · 12 NOVEMBER 2026

# Installing EgoCraft on Windows 11

How to install it, get past Windows' first warning, and try it out. It takes about five minutes, and you don't need to be an administrator.

## Installing

1 **Get the file**

You need `EgoCraft-windows-setup.exe`. If you were sent `egocraft.zip`, right-click it in your **Downloads** folder, choose **Extract All...**, then **Extract**. The installer and this guide are inside.

If Edge says the file "isn't commonly downloaded", click **...** next to it, then **Keep**, then **Show more** ▸ **Keep anyway**. EgoCraft needs Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit); nothing else needs installing first.

2 **Run the installer**

Double-click `EgoCraft-windows-setup.exe`. Because EgoCraft isn't signed yet, Windows may first show a blue box saying **Windows protected your PC**:

- Click **More info**.
- Check that it names **EgoCraft**, then click **Run anyway**.

Click **Next** through the installer; the folder it suggests is fine. EgoCraft is installed for you alone, in your own user folder, so Windows doesn't ask for an administrator password. On the last page, tick **Create desktop shortcut** if you want one, leave **Run EgoCraft** ticked, and click **Finish**.

> You only do this once. From then on, open EgoCraft from the **Start** menu like any other app.

## Trying it

**Start with the sample study**

Click **Open the sample study**: a made-up study of 200 people in two waves, with egos, alters and the ties between them, so every screen has something in it. Use the steps on the left (**Checks**, **Data**, **Sociograms**, **Measures**, **Results**) to walk through it.

**Your own study**

- Click **Start a new study**, then choose your ego, alter and tie files on **Import**, or drag them onto the boxes. CSV, Excel, Stata, SPSS and R files all work, as do exports from Network Canvas, EgoWeb, EgoNet and E-Net.
- On **Results**, **Save the results (ZIP)** saves one row per ego with the codebook, and the **Stata do-file** and **R script** buttons save the code that reproduces every number.
- Saved files go to your **Downloads** folder, and EgoCraft says where each one went.

**Where your studies are kept**

The open study is kept inside the EgoCraft app on this computer, so it is still there next time. That is separate from EgoCraft in a web browser, on an iPad or in Pinokio: to bring a study across, use **Save as a file** there and **Open a study file** here.

Use **Save as a file** now and then to keep a copy ( `.egocraft` ) you can back up or share. Everything stays on this computer: EgoCraft sends nothing anywhere.

## If something goes wrong

**"Smart App Control blocked an app that may be unsafe"**

Some Windows 11 computers have Smart App Control turned on, and it blocks unsigned apps with no **Run anyway** button. Don't turn it off for EgoCraft. Use the web version instead: open **nu-stats.github.io/egocraft** in Edge. It is the same app, keeps your studies in the browser, and works offline once opened. Your IT department may also be able to allow the installer.

**The window opens blank**

EgoCraft draws its window with Microsoft Edge WebView2, which is part of Windows 11. On an older or trimmed-down Windows, install the **WebView2 Runtime** from Microsoft's website, then open EgoCraft again.

**Removing it**

Save any study you want to keep as a file first. Then open **Start ▸ Settings ▸ Apps ▸ Installed apps**, find **EgoCraft**, click **…** and choose **Uninstall**.

## What to send back

- Did the installer run after **Run anyway**, or did Smart App Control block it?
- Your Windows version (**Start ▸ Settings ▸ System ▸ About**).
- Whether dragging files onto **Import** worked, and whether saved files landed in Downloads.
- Screenshots of anything odd or confusing.

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